Idea Space: the new data model

Issue #203, step 1 · version 3.11.0 · What changes under the Idea board, and what happens to the ideas you already have. Everything below was produced by running the real migration and services on a database seeded with ideas of the old model.

In short. Ideas now have **stages** (Inbox, Exploring, Ready, Building, Parked, Shipped, Archived), a park-until date, an archive reason, a source and a page body. Assumptions are **records** with impact, status, evidence and an optional test ticket. Ideas may belong to **no project**, people can **vote**, and every activity entry has an **author**. The current Idea board is unchanged and keeps working.

1. Existing ideas are converted once

On first start after the update. Eleven ideas of the old model (one per case) and where they land:

IDEA	TODAY	OLD STATUS	BECOMES	DETAIL
IDEA-1	Never edited	`draft`	inbox	
IDEA-2	Edited, 3 assumptions	`draft`	exploring	
IDEA-3	In review	`in_review`	exploring	
IDEA-4	Approved, not promoted	`approved`	ready	
IDEA-5	Promoted, ticket Done	`approved`	shipped	
IDEA-6	Promoted, ticket in progress	`approved`	building	
IDEA-7	Promoted, ticket Won’t do	`approved`	exploring	
IDEA-8	Promoted, ticket deleted	`approved`	ready	ticket link cleared
IDEA-9	Dropped	`dropped`	archived	Imported from the old Idea Space
IDEA-10	Revisit date in the future	`in_review`	parked	park until 2999-01-01
IDEA-11	Revisit date in the past	`in_review`	parked	park until 2020-01-01

2. Nothing is lost

A backup comes first. Before converting, the database is copied next to itself:

```
kanban.before-idea-space-20261029-225122.db
(632 KB)
```

The copy has the old shape (no `stage` column) and all 11 ideas. It is only made when there are ideas to convert.

Old fields stay in place: description, problem statement, microthoughts, ICE and energy are still stored. The new `body` and `details` are built from them:

```
body:
## Problem

The problem

Some text

details:
Energy: hot
ICE: impact 5, effort 2, confidence 4
```

Assumptions become records (same ids and text; “invalidated” is now “disproved”; impact starts at medium):

IDEA	ASSUMPTION	STATUS	IMPACT
IDEA-2	Users care	untested	medium
IDEA-2	It is cheap	validated	medium
IDEA-2	They pay	disproved	medium

Downgrading writes the assumptions back into the old JSON field, so a rollback keeps their latest status.

3. How it behaves now

Quick idea with no project. It lands in the Inbox:

```
id:         IDEA-12
project_id: null
stage:      inbox
source:     manual
```

An assumption record, as the API returns it:

```
{
  "id": "72cbebd6-4121-4cc2-836a-
8ced910cf9e6",
  "text": "People will pay for this",
  "status": "untested",
  "at": "2026-10-29T22:51:23.092071+00:00",
  "state": "testing",
  "impact": "high",
  "test_ticket_id": null,
  "evidence": []
}
```

The current board still works. It reads `status` (old words); the new fields ride along:

```
{
  "status": "invalidated",
  "state": "disproved",
  "impact": "medium"
}
```

Activity has an author:

ENTRY	BY
Idea created	Tuan
Assumption added	user
Assumption marked as testing	Tuan

A Building idea cannot be dropped
Trying to drop IDEA-6 (its ticket is in progress):

```
Not allowed while the ticket is open.
Close or remove the ticket first.
```

Parked ideas wake up
IDEA-11 was parked until 2020-01-01. On the first read it goes back to the Inbox, once:

```
stage: parked → inbox
park_until: None
```

4. What comes next

This is step 1 of the 9 in #203. The REST API and MCP for stage moves, votes, evidence and promote preview (step 2) and the new screens (steps 3 to 9) build on this model and land as their own pull requests.

Backend tests: the full suite passes, including 17 new tests for the migration and the model.